Position Paper

HEXAMUN'26 Conference
Allocation: Pierre Mendès France
Delegate: Jules Kitto-Astrop
Committee: Historical Crisis Committee (HCC)
Agenda: The Indochinese Independence Wars Against French Colonialism

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In 1940, we found ourselves in a position of inferiority against Nazi Germany and were required to surrender ourselves, shame washed over our nation and especially impacted the confidence of our military general Charles Huntziger. As a nation, we cannot allow a historical failure to impact our current targets which remain to retain control of the Indochina region including Vietnam, Laos, and Cambodia. I believe as the Prime Minister of France, that the Viet Minh does pose a genuine threat and our pride is interfering with our ability to effectively use our resources. We are not simply taking over the land, we are utilizing the Indochinese market as a means of selling French goods which allows us economic influence over Southeast Asia.

As we enter the next era of globalization, the French Union remains powerful enough to produce influence over the world through allied nations and colonies as well as associated states. Though our innovative capacity is strong and our resources are relatively abundant, I urge all members of the committee to be cautious of the use and depletion of resources as well as the political toll taken on our homeland, specifically in Paris. We cannot afford constant uprisings against our government as a result of our international relations, thus we must be highly strategic in our efforts to occupy and influence the Southeast Asian region. Our economic abilities, while larger than Vietnam's, are still finite. Our military spending must not exceed 30% of the fiscal budget at any point. Indochina is highly important in the French Union's globalization goal as it holds a plethora of natural resources that are otherwise scarce or unavailable in Europe. Furthermore, we must retain power over Vietnam to prevent the spread of communism across Southeast Asia and the world. I believe communist policies pose severe risks to economic growth and expansion of culture, education, and resources while also building a foundation for the violation of human rights and mass killings for expressing personal beliefs.

I believe that the solution to this seemingly inevitable war is to come to an agreement of influence and control allowed by the French Union while allowing each Indochinese nation to remain independent in their culture and decisions. I propose a combination of actions including the establishment of associated states of which are required to support France in its political conquests, and economic interdependence allowing both Indochina and France to engage in beneficial trade across the regions. The actions taken in regards to finding "peace with honor" requires oversight and thus I propose the establishment of an intergovernmental body with 2 representatives per state of the French Union. Without the French Union, Indochina lacks innovation and profit, with the French Union, nationalism rises and conflict is a matter of when and how. To prevent nationalist uprisings, I am able to agree with the implementation of a temporary divide between the Vietnamese land segregating the North and South into communist, and non-communist bases – respectively. I have 30 days to render this conflict a ceasefire, but we are all running out of time.

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